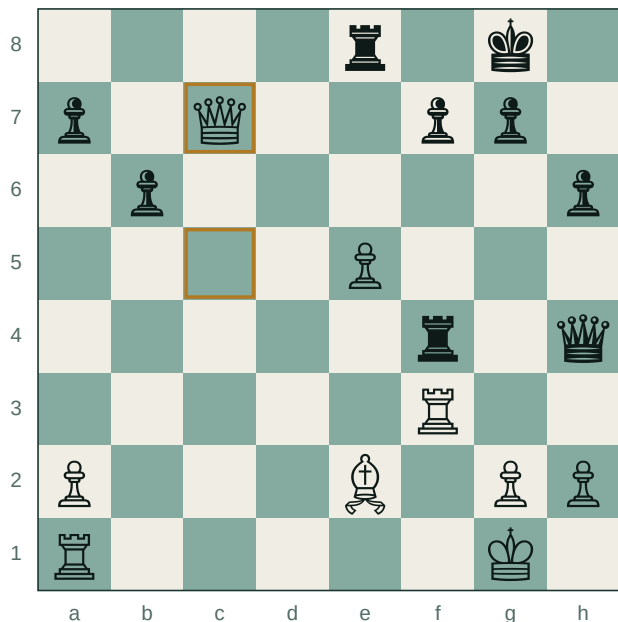


Clearance tactics: Black, move 22

Clearance tactics

Black to move



Previous move: 22.Qxc7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

22...Rxf3 23. gxf3 Qd4+ 24. Kg2 Qxa1

22...Rxf3 The rook captures the rook on f3. Recorded reply: **23.gxf3**.

23...Qd4+ Check restricts White to 3 legal replies here. From d4 it attacks king on g1 and rook on a1. Recorded reply: **24.Kg2**.

24...Qxa1 The queen captures the rook on a1.

At the end, nominal material is White 16 / Black 19 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Opening a line helps only if your next move is timely. The defender may close the line or create a stronger threat.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A clearance move vacates a square or opens a line for another piece. The clearing piece may sacrifice itself to gain the time needed for the follow-up.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the rook, bishop, queen, or knight that needs access, then locate the friendly piece blocking its route or destination.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on c7 and bishop on e2. Check for tactical protection.